

When analyzing multiple outcomes separately, **group your results section by outcome** rather than by analysis type. This organization improves clarity and readability by keeping all information about each outcome together.

Why group by outcome

Grouping by outcome helps readers:

- Follow the story of each outcome from descriptive statistics through final results
- Compare findings across outcomes more easily
- Understand the complete picture for each outcome before moving to the next
- Navigate directly to outcomes of interest

How to organize by outcome

For each outcome, present:

1. Descriptive statistics
2. Main analysis results
3. Sensitivity analyses
4. Subgroup analyses (if applicable)

Structure:

Results

Outcome 1: Mortality

Descriptive statistics

Main analysis

Sensitivity analyses

Subgroup analyses

Outcome 2: Hospital readmission

Descriptive statistics

Main analysis

Sensitivity analyses

Subgroup analyses

Outcome 3: Quality of life

Descriptive statistics

Main analysis

Sensitivity analyses

Subgroup analyses

What to avoid

Don't group by analysis type when outcomes are analyzed separately:

Results (POOR ORGANIZATION)

- Descriptive statistics
 - Mortality
 - Hospital readmission
 - Quality of life
- Main analyses
 - Mortality
 - Hospital readmission
 - Quality of life
- Sensitivity analyses
 - Mortality
 - Hospital readmission
 - Quality of life

This forces readers to jump back and forth between sections to understand the complete story for any single outcome.

Exception: Shared descriptive statistics

If your descriptive statistics apply to all outcomes (e.g., baseline characteristics in a clinical trial), present them once at the beginning before discussing individual outcomes.